

VALUE-ADD · INCLUDED AT NO CHARGE

The RentBureau Advantage

We report your bad-debt tenants to the database landlords actually screen — at no additional cost

Once an evicted or skipped tenant moves on, most recovery leverage moves with them. A collection tradeline on a general credit file helps — but there is a far sharper tool for a landlord: reporting the unpaid balance to **Experian RentBureau**, the rental-payment database the multifamily industry uses to screen its next applicants. Southwest Recovery Services furnishes to RentBureau on your behalf as part of standard placement — at no additional charge.

What Experian RentBureau is

RentBureau is the largest and most widely used rental-payment database in the country. It is an FCRA-regulated consumer reporting resource built specifically for the rental industry:

THE DATABASE	WHY IT MATTERS
9M+ residents	Rental histories on more than nine million residents nationwide — the largest such database.
3,000+ communities, every 24 hours	Thousands of apartment communities furnish payment data daily, and it also ingests data from electronic rent-payment services and collection companies.
Feeds tenant screening	RentBureau data flows into the resident-screening reports property managers pull on applicants — through Experian and its screening partners.
FCRA-regulated	A consumer reporting resource governed by the Fair Credit Reporting Act — accuracy, notice and dispute rights apply.

Why this is uniquely powerful for a landlord

A general collection tradeline sits on a credit file a lender might check. RentBureau data sits in the exact report the *next landlord* pulls when your former tenant applies for their next apartment. That difference is the whole point:

- **The balance follows them to their next lease.** When a skipped tenant applies elsewhere, the unpaid balance can surface in that community's screening report — precisely when they most want it gone.
- **It is targeted leverage.** Nothing motivates payment like an obstacle to the next apartment. This reaches the tenant where a generic dunning letter never will.
- **It protects the rental community.** Reporting warns other operators about a genuine risk — the same protection you benefit from when screening your own applicants.

Why you can't easily do this yourself

Credit and rental bureaus only accept data from approved **furnishers** that meet strict FCRA standards — the accuracy controls, dispute handling and data-security requirements most individual landlords and mid-size operators cannot stand up on their own. Southwest Recovery Services is an established furnisher. We report on your behalf, correctly, as part of the work — so you get the leverage without building the compliance infrastructure.

What we report — and how we keep it compliant

- **Consumer bureaus:** qualifying collection balances are furnished to **Equifax and Experian**.
- **Rental-specific:** the balance is reported to **Experian RentBureau**, where it can appear in the resident-screening reports other operators rely on.
- **Compliant by design:** every furnish is accurate, complete and verifiable; the consumer is notified as required; and disputes are investigated within the FCRA's 30-day window. Correct reporting is leverage that protects you from liability — not the kind that creates it.

Positive data works too: RentBureau also captures on-time rental payments, which can help responsible residents build credit. If you want to report positive resident payment history as a resident benefit, we can help you stand that up as well.

The value-add: included, at no charge

RentBureau reporting is bundled into standard contingency placement — there is no separate fee for it. You already pay nothing unless we recover; the reporting that gives you leverage on every placed account comes with the service. It is one of the clearest reasons to place bad-debt tenants with Southwest Recovery Services rather than write them off.

How placement works — and what you provide

RentBureau reporting rides on standard placement, so starting is deliberately light-lift. For each former-tenant balance, send what your property-management system already holds; we map your export once, and every future placement takes minutes:

YOU PROVIDE	WHY IT MATTERS
Tenant name & last known contact	The starting point for skip tracing — we locate the current address, phone and employment data from there, refreshed daily for as long as the account is worked.
Final account statement	The itemized balance — unpaid rent, lease-break fees, damage beyond the deposit — that becomes the reported and recovered amount.
Lease agreement	The contract that establishes the obligation — the document that resolves most disputes before they start.
Move-out reconciliation & photos	Deposit application and damage documentation — the evidence that supports both recovery and accurate furnishing.
Your ledger of payments	Including partial payments — so the reported balance is precise and FCRA-clean from day one.

From placement, the sequence is immediate: skip tracing and outreach begin within 24–48 hours, qualifying balances are furnished to the bureaus and RentBureau in the normal reporting cycle, and every account stays visible to your team in the client portal — status, contacts, recoveries and remittances, on demand. When a former tenant applies for their next apartment and the balance surfaces in screening, the call that follows is the one we’ve been waiting for — and it happens on accounts that letters alone would never have moved. The economics stay simple throughout: contingency-only, no upfront fee, and the reporting leverage included at no additional charge on every placed account.

The practical takeaway for an operator is a standing rule, not a one-off decision: every move-out that leaves an unpaid final statement places automatically — typically at 30–60 days, while the trail is freshest — so the skip tracing starts early, the reporting cycle begins sooner, and the balance is already waiting in the screening data by the time your former tenant applies for their next lease. Written off, these balances return nothing; placed on a schedule, they become a recurring stream of recovered NOI that costs the property nothing to pursue.

And because RentBureau data is what the industry itself screens against, the benefit compounds portfolio-wide: every operator who reports strengthens the screening data every other operator relies on — including yours. Placing your bad-debt tenants doesn’t just recover your balances; it makes the next application you screen more honest.

From placement to the next lease: what to expect

The RentBureau mechanism plays out on a predictable timeline — and knowing it helps set expectations for when recoveries land:

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
Days 0–2	Placement is validated and skip tracing runs — the former tenant’s current address, phone and employment data are located and refreshed daily thereafter.
Days 2–7	Compliant outreach opens: professional contact on the located data, validation notice delivered, payment and plan options on the table from the first conversation.
First reporting cycle	Qualifying unresolved balances are furnished to Equifax, Experian and RentBureau — accurate, complete, and dispute-ready under the FCRA.
The screening moment	Whenever the former tenant next applies — weeks or months later — the balance can surface in that community’s screening report. Calls that letters never earned tend to arrive within days of a denied or conditioned application.
Resolution & remittance	Payments and settlements post to your portal in real time; resolved accounts are updated with the bureaus promptly, and recovered funds remit on the standard cycle.

Two practical notes complete the picture. First, recoveries on former-tenant balances arrive in waves rather than a steady drip — an early wave from outreach on freshly located tenants, then a long tail triggered by screening moments as former tenants re-enter the rental market; both waves belong to whoever placed the account. Second, the leverage is entirely compliant by construction: nothing is threatened and nothing needs to be — the screening system the industry already uses simply does its job, and your balance is in the data when it does.

For oversight, three numbers tell an owner or regional manager the whole story, all visible in the portal on demand: **recovery rate by placement age** (the proof that fresh placement outperforms the annual cleanup), **the share of**

resolutions that follow a screening event (the RentBureau effect, measured), and **net-back after fees** — which, on a contingency-only model with reporting included at no charge, has a floor of exactly zero cost. Reviewed quarterly, those three measures turn a collections vendor into an accountable line item: recovered NOI, from balances that used to be write-offs, produced by a mechanism no individual landlord could operate alone.

COMMON QUESTION	THE SHORT ANSWER
Does reporting need anything from my staff?	No — furnishing is part of standard placement. Your team places the account once; the reporting, updates and dispute handling are ours.
What if the former tenant disputes?	Disputes are investigated within the FCRA's 30-day window against your lease, ledger and move-out documentation — another reason complete placement files matter.
When does reporting stop?	The moment an account resolves — paid or settled — the tradeline is updated promptly. Accurate exit reporting is as important to compliance as accurate entry.

About Southwest Recovery Services

Southwest Recovery Services is a property-management and multifamily recovery specialist working post-eviction and unpaid-rent balances on pure contingency since 2004 — with a strong Texas footprint of six offices (Addison HQ, Austin, Dallas, Houston, Midland, San Antonio) among twelve across seven states, and recovery reach nationwide. Over two decades we have placed more than \$975M in receivables, recovered over \$76M for clients, and worked 800,000+ accounts. We furnish qualifying accounts to Equifax and Experian, plus Experian RentBureau — the rental-specific value-add most landlords cannot report themselves — at no additional charge, and we work every account on pure contingency (\$0 upfront) under a documented, FDCPA/Reg F-compliant process as an ACA International member.

Put the whole rental industry's screening behind your recovery

Place your post-eviction and skipped-tenant balances with us and we'll work them on pure contingency — and report them to Experian RentBureau at no additional cost. Send a representative sample and we'll show you exactly how it works.

Call [\(866\) 551-4684](tel:8665514684) · sdietz@swrecovery.com · swrecovery.com

Provided for general informational purposes; not legal advice. Recovery figures are illustrative and vary by portfolio; statutes and court timelines vary by jurisdiction — confirm with counsel. Southwest Recovery Services does not collect consumer debt in California, Oregon or Washington.